The Temple Falls

2 Kings 21–25 · Jeremiah 7 · Psalm 137

The big idea: Judah trusted the temple instead of the God who lived there. God sent his messengers persistently, out of compassion, and Judah mocked them until there was no remedy. In 586 BC Babylon burned the temple. When there was no remedy in us, God provided one in Christ.

Before you meet: Read

2 Kings 23:25–27 | Jeremiah 7:1–11 | 2 Chronicles 36:15–21 | Psalm 137:1–4

Open (5 minutes)

Have you ever moved somewhere you did not want to go, or lost something you thought you would always have? What was that like?

Observe (fill in from the passage)

"Do not trust in these deceptive words: 'This is the _____ of the LORD, the temple of the LORD, the temple of the LORD.'" *(Jeremiah 7:4)*

"By the waters of Babylon, there we sat down and _____, when we remembered Zion." *(Psalm 137:1)*

"...until the wrath of the LORD rose against his people, until there was no _____." *(2 Chronicles 36:16)*

Discuss

1. Judah trusted that God would never let his own temple fall. What sure things do people trust in place of God himself? *Jeremiah 7:4–11*

2. Psalm 137 asks how to sing the LORD's song in a foreign land. Have you ever felt that way? What helped? *Psalm 137:1–4*

3. Even Manasseh was heard when he humbled himself. Is there anyone you have quietly decided is too far gone for grace? *2 Chronicles 33:12–13*

Memory verse

> *"but God shows his love for us in that while we were still sinners, Christ died for us."*
>
> **Romans 5:8**

Pray

Ask God to show you anything you trust in place of him. Thank him that when there was no remedy in us, he gave his Son.

LEADER NOTES · WEEK 33

The Temple Falls

Session plan (about 45 minutes)

5 min	Welcome, opening prayer, and the Open question.
10 min	Read Jeremiah 7:1–11 and 2 Chronicles 36:15–21 aloud together.
5 min	Observe: work through the fill-ins together. Use the answer key below.
20 min	Discuss: choose three of the questions.
5 min	Pray together. Introduce the memory verse and next week's reading (Jeremiah 29:1–14 and 31:31–34, and Daniel 3 and 6).

Main points to land

1. Judah ignored God's prophets and trusted the temple building instead of God, until there was no remedy (Jeremiah 7:4; 2 Chronicles 36:15–16).
2. Babylon came in waves (605, 597, 586 BC) and burned the temple. God's glory had already departed (2 Kings 25:9; Ezekiel 10:18–19).
3. Even Manasseh, the worst of Judah's kings, humbled himself in chains, and God heard him. No one is too far gone for grace (2 Chr. 33:12–13).

Answer key (Observe)

1. temple
2. wept
3. remedy

Questions people will ask

Why would God let his own temple be destroyed?
He had warned for centuries through his prophets, and his people kept trusting a building while worshiping idols (Jeremiah 7:4–11; 2 Chronicles 36:15–16). The exile was judgment, but also discipline meant to bring them back. God's presence was never limited to a building (Ezekiel 11:16).

Closing prayer

Father, you sent your messengers to Judah again and again because you had compassion on them. Forgive us for trusting things in place of you. Thank you that when there was no remedy in us, you sent your Son. Amen.